

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF

Module title	Finance & Accounting for Business
Module code	BUS7C2
Module leader	Taofik Adeosun
Assessment title	Assessment 2
Launch date	1 st August 2025
Submission deadline	16 th September 2025 @ 16:00 pm UK time.
Expected date for return of marks and feedback	<i>What kind of feedback can students expect and when?</i> 10th October 2025@15.00pm UK time Summary feedback, grade mark.
Module outcomes assessed	3. Critically analyse and interpret financial figures including cash flows. 4. Critically appraise the conceptual frameworks of financial reporting for companies for evaluating international corporate performance. 5. Critically examine the principles of finance and the structure of national and international financial markets.
Assessment weighting	50%
Word count (if relevant)	2,500 words
Assessment task details - provide a description of the task	
Question A (40 marks) Apple's income statement, balance sheet, and cash flow statement are provided below for the years 2021, 2022, 2023 in Exhibit 1, 2 and 3 respectively. You are a Finance Analyst, and your manager has asked you to do the following: For each year, 2022 and 2023; calculate 2 Profitability Return Ratios, 2 Profitability Margin Ratios, 2 Gearing Ratios, 2 Liquidity Ratios and 2 Efficiency Ratios (<i>Asset Turnover Ratio and Inventory Turnover Ratio</i>).	

Please put your result on a table, and within your table state the formula used for each set of ratios. Your table should fit on to one page
(10 marks)

- ii. Critically evaluate Apple's performance on each set of ratios from 2022 to 2023. How would you suggest improving each set of ratios?
(15 marks)
- iii. Assess the role of financial ratios in evaluating corporate performance, and formulate a conclusion on their overall effectiveness
(15 marks)

Question B (40 marks)

Over the past decade, UK SME finance markets have undergone notable shifts in both structure and usage patterns. [*The British Business Bank's Small Business Finance Markets 2023/24 report*](#) reveals debt finance continues to dominate SME funding, with bank lending, asset finance, and private debt funds accounting for the majority of external finance. Meanwhile, equity finance — although critical for scaling innovative startups — has contracted sharply, with deal volumes halving in 2023, exposing regional disparities and persistent barriers for underserved groups. The diversification of lenders (including challenger banks, non-bank providers, and fintech platforms) has improved access and flexibility, but also exposed structural mismatches between financial products and the evolving needs of UK businesses. This dynamic financial landscape reflects broader macroeconomic pressures, investor sentiment, and the strategic financing choices facing firms at different stages of their lifecycle.

- i. **Critically examine** the principal and emerging types of debt and equity finance available to UK small businesses, providing a structured classification based on financial instrument characteristics and accessibility. (15 marks)
- ii. **Evaluate** the relative merits and limitations of each in the current UK economic and regulatory landscape. (10 marks)
- iii. **Assess** their suitability across SME lifecycle stages (start-up, growth, maturity) and **interpret** what recent funding trends reveal about market sentiment and capital flows. (15 marks)

Please note:

- i. To achieve good marks your assignment should show detailed evidence of **research** and **critical analysis**.
- ii. Marks are available for presentation and quality of English (10 marks), and proper referencing according to the Wrexham University Harvard method (10 marks); **(20 marks)**
- iii. This assignment carries 50% of the total module weighting

(Total 100 marks)

Submission instructions - What should be the format of the submission? / Where should it be submitted?

e.g. A single Word document only, containing your assignment and a reference list. No appendices are required. Please submit online via the appropriate Turnitin submission on the module space.

Exhibit 1. Apple Income Statement 2021-2023 (\$ Millions)

	Years ended		
	September 30, 2023	September 24, 2022	September 25, 2021
Net sales:			
Products	\$298,085	\$ 316,199	\$ 297,392
Services	85,200	78,129	68,425
Total net sales	383,285	394,328	365,817
Cost of sales:			
Products	189,282	201,471	192,266
Services	24,855	22,075	20,715
Total cost of sales	214,137	223,546	212,981
Gross margin	169,148	170,782	152,836
Operating expenses:			
Research and development	29,915	26,251	21,914
Selling, general and administrative	24,932	25,094	21,973
Total operating expenses	54,847	51,345	43,887
Operating income	114,301	119,437	108,949
Other income/expense), net	(565)	(334)	258
Income before provision for income taxes	113,736	119,103	109,207
Provision for income taxes	16,741	19,300	14,527
Net income	\$ 96,995	\$ 99,803	\$ 94,680

	September 30, 2023	September 24, 2022	September 25, 2021
ASSETS:			
Current assets:			
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 29,965	\$ 23,646	\$ 34,940
Marketable securities	31,590	24,658	27,699
Accounts receivable, net	29,508	28,184	26,278
Vendor non-trade receivables	31,477	32,748	6,580
Inventories	6,331	4,946	25,228
Other current assets	14,695	21,223	14,111
Total current assets	143,566	135,405	134,836
Non-current assets:			
Marketable securities	100,544	120,805	127,877
Property, plant and equipment, net	43,715	42,117	39,440
Other non-current assets	64,758	54,428	48,849
Total non-current assets	209,017	217,350	216,166
Total assets	\$ 352,583	\$ 352,755	\$ 351,002
LIABILITIES AND SHAREHOLDERS' EQUITY:			
Current liabilities:			
Accounts payable	\$ 62,611	\$ 64,115	\$ 54,763
Other current liabilities	58,829	60,845	47,493
Deferred revenue	8,061	7,912	7,612
Commercial paper	5,985	9,982	6,000
Term debt	9,822	11,128	9,613
Total current liabilities	145,308	153,982	125,481
Non-current liabilities:			

Prifysgol Wreccsam Wrexham University

Term debt	95,281	98,959	109,106
Other non-current liabilities	49,848	49,142	53,325
Total non-current liabilities	145,129	148,101	162,431
Total liabilities	290,437	302,083	287,912
Shareholders' equity:			
Common stock and additional paid-in capital, \$0.00001 par value: 50,400,000 shares			
authorized; 15,550,061 and 15,943,425 shares issued and outstanding, respectively	73,812	64,849	57,365
Accumulated deficit	(214)	(3,068)	5,562
Accumulated other comprehensive loss	(11,452)	(11,109)	163
Total shareholders' equity	62,146	50,672	63,090
Total liabilities and shareholders' equity	\$ 352,583	\$ 352,755	\$ 351,002

Exhibit 3: Cash flow Statement 2021-2023

	Years ended		
	September 30, 2023	September 24, 2022	September 25, 2021
Cash, cash equivalents and restricted cash, beginning balances	\$ 24,977	\$ 35,929	\$ 39,789
Operating activities:			
Net income	96,995	99,803	94,680
Adjustments to reconcile net income to cash generated by operating activities:			
Depreciation and amortization	11,519	11,104	11,284
Share-based compensation expense	10,833	9,038	7,906
Other	(2,227)	1,006	(4,921)
Changes in operating assets and liabilities:			
Accounts receivable, net	(1,688)	(1,823)	(10,125)
Vendor non-trade receivables	1,271	(7,520)	(3,903)
Inventories	(1,618)	1,484	(2,642)
Other current and non-current assets	(5,684)	(6,499)	(8,042)
Accounts payable	(1,889)	9,448	12,326
Other current and non-current liabilities	3,031	6,110	7,475
Cash generated by operating activities	110,543	122,151	104,038
Investing activities:			
Purchases of marketable securities	(29,513)	(76,923)	(109,558)
Proceeds from maturities of marketable securities	39,686	29,917	59,023
Proceeds from sales of marketable securities	5,828	37,446	47,460
Payments for acquisition of property, plant and equipment	(10,959)	(10,708)	(11,085)
Other	(1,337)	(2,086)	(385)
Cash generated by/(used in) investing activities	3,705	(22,354)	(14,545)

Financing activities:

Payments for taxes related to net share settlement of equity awards

	(5,431)	(6,223)	(6,556)
Payments for dividends and dividend equivalents	(15,025)	(14,841)	(14,467)
Repurchases of common stock	(77,550)	(89,402)	(85,971)
Proceeds from issuance of term debt, net	5,228	5,465	20,393
Repayments of term debt	(11,151)	(9,543)	(8,750)
Proceeds from/(Repayments of) commercial paper, net	(3,978)	3,955	1,022
Other	(581)	(160)	976
Cash used in financing activities	(108,488)	(110,749)	(93,353)
increase/(Decrease) in cash, cash equivalents and restricted cash	5,760	(10,952)	(3,860)
Cash, cash equivalents and restricted cash, ending balances	\$ 30,737	\$ 24,977	\$ 35,929

Hints and tips

All submitted work is expected to observe academic standards in terms of referencing, academic writing, use of language etc. Failure to adhere to these instructions may result in your work being awarded a lower grade than it would otherwise deserve.

Marking and moderation

All submissions would be moderated.

Marking Criteria attached to the brief.

Employability Skills Applied

On successful completion of this module, a student will have had opportunities to demonstrate achievement of the following Employability Skills.

Tick all that apply.

CORE ATTRIBUTES

Engaged	✓
Creative	
Enterprising	✓
Ethical	✓

KEY ATTITUDES	
Commitment	
Curiosity	✓
Resilient	
Confidence	✓
Adaptability	✓
PRACTICAL SKILLSETS	
Digital fluency	✓
Organisation	✓
Leadership and team working	
Critical thinking	✓
Emotional intelligence	
Communication	✓

Marking criteria

Assessment Criteria	Marks Available
Calculate 10 financial ratios of Apple Inc for 2022 and 2023, within a table fitted on one page. Show formula for each set of ratios.	10
Critically evaluate Apple's performance on each set of ratios from 2022 to 2023. How would you suggest improving each set of ratios?	15
Assess the role of financial ratios in evaluating corporate performance, and formulate a conclusion on their overall effectiveness	15
Critically examine the principal and emerging types of debt and equity finance available to UK small businesses, providing a structured classification based on financial instrument characteristics and accessibility.	15
Evaluate the relative merits and limitations of each in the current UK economic and regulatory landscape	10
Assess their suitability across SME lifecycle stages (start-up, growth, maturity) and interpret what recent funding trends reveal about market sentiment and capital flows	15
Wide ranging references with the correct use of the Wrexham University Harvard reference system	10
Quality of the written work. Clear structure to the work, presentation and correct spelling was used throughout. Good use of English language.	10
Total	100

Grade Boundaries %	0	1-29%	30-39%	40 – 49%	50 – 59%	60 – 69%	70 – 79%	80 – 89%	90-100%	Total
	N.S	Unsatisfactory	Minimum	Satisfactory	Fairly good	Good	Excellent	Exceptional	Outstanding	
Criteria/Learning outcomes										
Criteria 1: Analysis across the range of aspects: profitability, efficiency, liquidity, gearing and investment. (You need to select two ratios from each section and need to show your ratio calculations) 30%		Does not meet the learning outcome and criteria to pass the assignment	Minimum systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Lacks critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Little to no evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Ideas are poorly communicated.	Some basic systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Limited critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Limited evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Limited communication of ideas.	Reasonable systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Some critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Some evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Fairly good communication of ideas.	Good systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Good critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Good evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Good communication of ideas.	Excellent systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Excellent critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Substantial evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Excellent communication of ideas.	Exceptional systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Exceptional critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Extensive evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Exceptional communication of ideas.	Outstanding systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Outstanding critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Unprecedented evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Outstanding communication of ideas.	
Criteria 2: Interpretation of the ratio analysis and the commentary (Where appropriate you should identify any potential interrelationships between aspects). 30%		Does not meet the learning outcome and criteria to pass the assignment	Minimum systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Lacks critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Little to no evidence of autonomy in planning	Some basic systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Limited critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Limited evidence of autonomy	Reasonable systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Some critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Some evidence of autonomy	Good systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Good critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Good evidence of autonomy	Excellent systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Excellent critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Substantial evidence	Exceptional systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Exceptional critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Extensive evidence of autonomy in	Outstanding systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Outstanding critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Unprecedented evidence	

			and organisation of work. Ideas are poorly communicated.	in planning and organisation of work. Limited communication of ideas.	in planning and organisation of work. Fairly good communication of ideas.	in planning and organisation of work. Good communication of ideas.	of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Excellent communication of ideas.	planning and organisation of work. Exceptional communication of ideas.	of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Outstanding communication of ideas.	
Criteria 3: Explanation of the investor considerations for a UK company investment decision making and any further information that may be required when addressing the concerns of any potential investors. 25%		Does not meet the learning outcome and criteria to pass the assignment	Minimum systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Lacks critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Little to no evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Ideas are poorly communicated.	Some basic systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Limited critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Limited evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Limited communication of ideas.	Reasonable systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Some critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Some evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Fairly good communication of ideas.	Good systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Good critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Good evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Good communication of ideas.	Excellent systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Excellent critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Substantial evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Excellent communication of ideas.	Exceptional systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Exceptional critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Extensive evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Exceptional communication of ideas.	Outstanding systematic understanding of knowledge with critical awareness of current issues and insights unsupported by research. Outstanding critical evaluation, creativity and original application of knowledge. Unprecedented evidence of autonomy in planning and organisation of work. Outstanding communication of ideas.	
Criteria 4: Good use of sources and use of Wrexham University Harvard referencing 5%		Inadequate or incomplete	No references in text with errors in text and list of sources and/or only websites used.	Many omissions of references and format errors in text with omissions and format errors on list of sources.	Occasional omission of reference in text with some format errors in text and list of sources. Limited range of source material.	Good range of source material. All sources acknowledged in text with minor format error in text or list of sources.	Broad range of source material. All sources acknowledged in text and appropriately referenced in line with WU Harvard referencing.	Exceptional range of source material. All sources acknowledged in text and appropriately referenced in line with WU Harvard referencing.	Outstanding range of current and field leading source material. All sources acknowledged in text and appropriately referenced in line with WU Harvard referencing.	
Criteria 5: Quality of the written work. Clear structure to the work and correct spelling was used throughout. Good use of English language.		Inadequate or incomplete	Written to a poor standard, poor English, and Grammar.	Basic attempt to construct a fluent and coherent argument. Spelling mistakes and grammatical errors present. Accurate and written to a satisfactory standard.	Reasonable attempt to construct a fluent and coherent argument. Legible and carefully proofread. Spelling mistakes and grammatical errors non-existent). Accurate and	Good attempt to construct a fluent and coherent argument. Legible and carefully proofread Spelling mistakes and grammatical errors non-existent. Accurate and	Power and persuasive conclusion made, based upon the analysis/evaluation presented. Spelling mistakes and grammatical errors non-existent. Accurate and written	Exceptionally powerful and persuasive conclusion made, based upon the analysis/evaluation presented. Spelling mistakes and grammatical errors non-existent. Accurate and written to a very exceptional standard.	Outstanding, original, and persuasive conclusion made, based upon the analysis/evaluation presented. Spelling mistakes and grammatical errors non-existent. Accurate and	

10%					written to an adequate standard.	written to a very good standard.	to a very excellent standard		written to an outstanding standard	
All marks/grades remain indicative until they have been considered and confirmed by the Assessment Board- Total										

	%	Criteria
Distinction	90-100	Outstanding: Outstanding systematic understanding of knowledge and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, informed by the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. The work demonstrates an outstanding knowledge of techniques applicable to research and advanced scholarship. Application of knowledge is original with outstanding practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the subject discipline. Work evidences outstanding critical evaluation of current research, advanced scholarship and methodologies to propose new hypotheses if appropriate. There is evidence of outstanding systematic and creative management of complex issues to make sound judgements in the absence of complete data. Outstanding communication of conclusions to specialist and non-specialist audiences. Outstanding self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems with evidence of an outstanding ability to advance personal knowledge and understanding and to develop new skills at a high level. An outstanding display of the qualities and transferable skills needed for employment that require initiative and personal responsibility, complex decision-making and independent learning for continued professional development.
	80-90	Exceptional: In most areas, the qualities required for the grade above are displayed, though there may be negligible errors.
	70-79	Excellent: In most areas, the qualities required for the grade above are displayed. There may be negligible errors and some minor inaccuracies/omissions.

	%	Criteria
Pass	60-69	Very Good: Very good systematic understanding of knowledge and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, informed by the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. The work demonstrates a very good knowledge of techniques applicable to research and advanced scholarship. Application of knowledge is original with very good practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the subject discipline. Work evidences very good critical evaluation of current research, advanced scholarship and methodologies to propose new hypotheses if appropriate. There is evidence of very good systematic and creative management of complex issues to make sound judgements in the absence of complete data. Very good communication of conclusions to specialist and non-specialist audiences. Very good self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems with evidence of a very good ability to advance personal knowledge and understanding and to develop new skills at a high level. A very good display of the qualities and transferable skills needed for employment that require initiative and personal responsibility, complex decision-making and independent learning for continued professional development.
	50-59	Fairly Good: Fairly good systematic understanding of knowledge and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, informed by the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. The work demonstrates a fairly good knowledge of techniques applicable to research and advanced scholarship. Application of knowledge is original with fairly good practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the subject discipline. Work evidences fairly good critical evaluation of current research, advanced scholarship and methodologies to propose new hypotheses if appropriate. There is evidence of fairly good systematic and creative management of complex issues to make sound judgements in the absence of complete data. Fairly good communication of conclusions to specialist and non-specialist audiences. Fairly good self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems with evidence of a fairly good ability to advance personal knowledge and understanding and to develop new skills at a high level. A fairly good display of the qualities and transferable skills needed for employment that require initiative and personal responsibility, complex decision-making and independent learning for continued professional development.

	%	Criteria
	40-49	Satisfactory: Satisfactory systematic understanding of knowledge and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, informed by the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. The work demonstrates a satisfactory knowledge of techniques applicable to research and advanced scholarship. Application of knowledge is original with satisfactory practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the subject discipline. Work evidences satisfactory critical evaluation of current research, advanced scholarship and methodologies to propose new hypotheses if appropriate. There is evidence of satisfactory systematic and creative management of complex issues to make sound judgements in the absence of complete data. Satisfactory communication of conclusions to specialist and non-specialist audiences. Satisfactory self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems with evidence of a satisfactory ability to advance personal knowledge and understanding and to develop new skills at a high level. A satisfactory display of the qualities and transferable skills needed for employment that require initiative and personal responsibility, complex decision-making and independent learning for continued professional development.
Refer/Fail	35-39	Marginal Refer/Fail: Some systematic understanding of knowledge and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, informed by the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. The work demonstrates some knowledge of techniques applicable to research and advanced scholarship. Application of knowledge is original with some practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the subject discipline. Work evidences limited critical evaluation of current research, advanced scholarship and methodologies to propose new hypotheses if appropriate. There is some evidence of systematic and creative management of complex issues to make sound judgements in the absence of complete data. Limited communication of conclusions to specialist and non-specialist audiences. Some self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems with evidence of a limited ability to advance personal knowledge and understanding and to develop new skills at a high level. A limited display of the qualities and transferable skills needed for employment that require initiative and personal responsibility, complex decision-making and independent learning for continued professional development. (<i>Compensation is possible within regulations of board for undergraduate & postgraduate level</i>).

	%	Criteria
--	---	----------

30-34	Refer/Fail: Minimal systematic understanding of knowledge and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, informed by the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. The work demonstrates minimal knowledge of techniques applicable to research and advanced scholarship. Application of knowledge is original with minimal practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the subject discipline. Work evidences minimal critical evaluation of current research, advanced scholarship and methodologies to propose new hypotheses if appropriate. Evidence of systematic and creative management of complex issues to make sound judgements in the absence of complete data is lacking. Limited communication of conclusions to specialist and non-specialist audiences. Minimal self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems with evidence of a limited ability to advance personal knowledge and understanding and to develop new skills at a high level. Minimal display of the qualities and transferable skills needed for employment that require initiative and personal responsibility, complex decision-making and independent learning for continued professional development.
1-29	Clear Refer/Fail: Unsatisfactory systematic understanding of knowledge and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, informed by the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. The work lacks knowledge of techniques applicable to research and advanced scholarship. Application of knowledge is unoriginal without practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the subject discipline. Work lacks critical evaluation of current research, advanced scholarship and methodologies to propose new hypotheses if appropriate. Evidence of systematic and creative management of complex issues to make sound judgements in the absence of complete data is insufficient. Poor communication of conclusions to specialist and non-specialist audiences. Inadequate self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems with little to no ability to advance personal knowledge and understanding and to develop new skills at a high level. Work does not display the qualities and transferable skills needed for employment that require initiative and personal responsibility, complex decision-making and independent learning for continued professional development.
0	Refer/Fail: Non-submission